



Google Fiber in Kansas

Google's "ultra high-speed fiber-to-the-home" internet services kicked-off in Kansas promising 1GBps internet speeds



DmC PS3 demo launch

DmC: Devil May Cry's PS3 launched in Japan, with different gameplay from previous builds, and a DLC: 'Vergil's Downfall'

Dell S2740L

Wonderful looks, decent performance, but a high asking price

Dell is renowned for its Ultrasharp series of monitors, but with the S2740L it is breaking away from that series to give us an LED backlit monitor with an IPS panel. The S2740L does not have the robust feature-set one expects from an Ultrasharp series monitor, but is geared more towards multimedia use or as a second TV screen for some. The Dell S2740L comes with an all-glass front face which merges with the bezel which prevents dust accumulation along the bezel of the monitor, but is a magnet for smudges and fingerprints. The operational panel is very similar to the one seen on other Dell and Alienware monitors, with touch buttons on the bottom right. The assembly of the monitor only allows you to tilt the display and the rear



Price
₹23,000

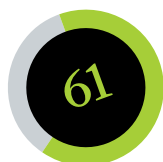
side has a smooth tapering design. Display ports are a bit too recessed for our liking. Build quality on the whole is quite sturdy.

When it came to performance, it gave a contrast ratio of 630:1 at brightness and contrast levels of 50 per cent. Black levels were not the best and thanks to the extremely glossy surface, during dark scenes the display tends to reflect a lot. In the Lagom.nl test, the black and white contrast tests were quite good but in the gradient banding test we noticed definite banding with a greenish tinge in the grey regions.

We did not notice any issues with noise or banding while watching HD clips. Skin tones looked great and even in fast-moving action scenes, there was no noticeable framing. Viewing angles are great thanks to the IPS display on the Dell S2740L.

The price of ₹23,000 for this monitor is on the higher side when compared with competing 27-inch monitors. In fact ASUS offers a 27-inch 3D monitor for around ₹1,000 less, while the BenQ GL2750 retails for ₹18,500.

Nimish Sawant



Features	50
Performance	65
Build Quality	75
Value for money	55

Specifications

Screen size: 27-inch; **Resolution:** 1920x1080; **Panel:** IPS; **Backlight:** LED; **Display Ports:** 1xHDMI, 1xDVI, 1xD-sub; **Tilt:** Yes; **Swivel:** No

Contact

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Sapphire Vapor-X HD 7770

A cool customer



Price
₹9,990

The Vapor-X edition card is a factory overclocked HD 7770 to 1100 MHz with a video memory of 1 GB. It runs cool with maximum load temperature at 56 degrees which is very good. Performance wise, it beats the MSI R7770 and ASUS HD 7770 DC by a small margin, but is still slower than the ZOTAC GTX 650 Ti. Unigine Heaven 2.5 gave 20 FPS on maximum settings, which was 2 FPS more than MSI R7770 and ASUS HD 7770. Most of the games are playable at 1080p Max settings except *Sniper Elite V*. At ₹9,990 it makes for a good purchase option.



Features	70
Performance	45
Build Quality	70
Value for money	65

Specifications

GPU Clock: 1100 MHz; **Memory Clock:** 5200MHz; **Memory Bus:** 128-bit; **Memory size:** 1024MB; **Display ports:** 2x DVI, 1x HDMI, 1x DisplayPort; **Stream Processors:** 640

Contact

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JBL OnBeat Venue

Surprisingly falls short on mid-range performance



Price
₹15,990

It's design is rather interesting and the OnBeat Venue does not come with a physical remote control. JBL tries to compensate this by offering an app for iOS toys.

Its voice clarity is acceptable for vocals with enough mid-range depth. We tested this with equaliser on the playback device set to off. Push up the volume above 50 per cent and the clarity goes down drastically. Bass is punchy, but definitely sounds doctored most of the time. It's expensive and doesn't perform as well as the Yamaha PDX-31 with a Logitech Bluetooth adapter, and just not worth it.



Features	65
Performance	60
Build Quality	70
Value for money	40

Specifications

Type: Audio Dock; **Compatible with:** iPod Touch, iPhone and iPad; **Connectivity:** Dock, Bluetooth and AUX-in; **Frequency Response:** 60Hz - 20KHz; **Input Impedance:** 8ohms; **Weight:** 2.25kg

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